GLOBAL INITIATIVES, CONFERENCES AND SUMMITS RELATING TO ENVIRONMENT SINCE 1972

As we have seen in Chapter 14, the whole initiative regarding the world environment took root with the formation of 'Club of Rome' in the year 1972. They argued that if the present increasing trend in population, food and pollution continue, given finite resource supplies, the limits to growth on the planet will be reached within the next 100 years and there would arise problems of sustainability.

The same year, the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment (also known as the **Stockholm Conference**) was held in Stockholm, Sweden, during 5–16 June 1972. It was the UN's first major conference on international environmental issues, and it marked a turning point in the development of international environmental politics. The **Declaration of the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment**, or **Stockholm Declaration**, was adopted on June 16, 1972 by the United Nations at the 21st plenary meeting as the first document in the international environmental law to recognize the right to a healthy environment.

The other landmarks in the environmental awareness thinking were obviously the *World Conservation Strategy* (1980), *Our Common Future* (1987), and *Caring for the Earth (*1991) (see Chapter 14).

Besides these landmark events in arousing environmental awareness, the other remarkable summits and conferences were as follows:

1. *UNEP, 1972:* United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) was formed as a result of the United Nations Conference on the Human Environment in June 1972. Its main function is to coordinate the UN environment programmes at the global and regional levels.

2. *Bucharest Population Conference, 1974:* The year 1974 had been designated as the World Population Year and with this theme in the backdrop, the first World Conference on Population was held in Bucharest, Romania under the auspices of the UN. 135 countries participated in the Conference. The Conference focused on the relationship between population issues and development, and proposed the World Population Plan of Action. It was followed up by